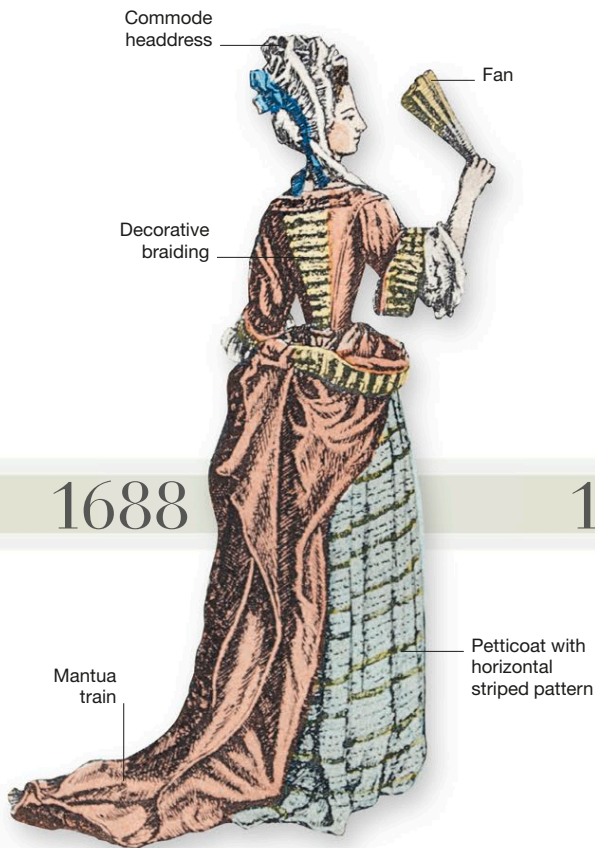




1688

**Folded train** Towards the end of the 17th century the train on the mantua became much longer. The sides were intricately folded and pinned up at the back of the skirt to reveal ever more elaborate linings.

1690



**Tall cap** The fontange cap was worn flat at the back of the head, rising up high above the crown in layers of lace and ribbon, often supported by a wire-frame commode. It was named after Madame Fontange, who originated the ribbon style.



1695

**Mantua and petticoat** By the end of the century the mantua and petticoat were made from matching fabric, with contrasting material used for the lining of the mantua. Petticoats were decorated with horizontal bands of lace or fringing (furbelows).



1715

**Wrapping gown** An informal robe known as a nightgown or wrapping gown fell loose from the shoulders and was worn over a bodice, petticoat, and linen smock or shift. A popular choice for portraits such as this one, it was seen as a timeless garment.

1720



**Riding dress** Women's riding habit evolved from male styles of dress, with a coat worn over a waistcoat and petticoat. The habit was often decorated with metal braiding and frogging (horizontal bands across the front).

## STAYS AND STOMACHER



Stays or bodices, still an essential part of women's dress, were made of whalebone stitched between two layers of buckram, a stiffened linen fabric. Bodices were often covered with embroidered silk; a decorated panel, or stomacher, might be worn over the top for further embellishment or contrast.